height, he had to step down unceremoniously on 18 August 2008, as he had been served an ultimatum by the political coalition that was then ruling Pakistan to resign by 19 August or face impeachment. What an inglorious end to his innings as the head of state! He lives in London these days, and according to media reports, he is contemplating a return to Pakistan to be in active politics and run for elections. I hope it is not another case of gross miscalculation on his part of his support base in Pakistan or in the hierarchy of its army. Anyway, it will be a test case and I wish him good luck. As of June 2011, besides the notices served to him to appear in the court at Rawalpindi as a 'proclaimed offender' and his failure to respond, Pakistani prosecutors are likely to proceed with impounding his assets, as per media reports. Time seems to be running out for him as the Pakistan government has issued an Interpol alert for his arrest.

As an army chief, purely from the professional point of view, I always considered myself as having an edge over my counterpart in Pakistan. There was nothing to distract me, and I could apply myself in a single-minded and focused manner to the task of leading the Indian Army. On the other hand, circumstantially, Musharraf had taken upon himself the responsibility of running the country as well. This was at the cost of motivating and inspiring his troops and the army, who would have liked to see more of their chief! A case in point: while I could make a number of visits to the border areas of Jammu and Kashmir and the northeast and do my best to pep up my officers and men, the same could not be said of my peer. Contrary to his actions after the coup d'etat, Musharraf in his book has himself stated that 'whenever the army gets involved with martial law, it gets distracted from its vital military duties. Military training and operational readiness suffer.' But the dichotomy in his words and actions stands out.

It is interesting to see two soldiers of the same era, with more or less the same background, growing up and professionally advancing right to the top rank of their armies, in two neighbouring countries that have fought four wars since their independence in 1947. Both of us experienced the vicissitudes of military life, but grew up in